MATH INQUIRERS PLACEMENT CHECK

Ages 8-9

For children finishing Primary 2 • About 30 minutes • No calculator

Name: _____ Date: _____

How it works. Your child answers on their own. Read a question aloud if they ask, but do not help with the maths. If they are stuck, say "Try your best, or skip it", and move on. Write the answer in the box. Working on scrap paper is fine.

Warm-up

1 What is 10 more than 64?

2 Which is smaller, 58 or 85?

3 What is 16 - 9?

4 What is 45 + 30?

Main questions

5 What is the value of the digit 6 in 462?

6 5_ + 27 = 81. What digit goes in the blank?

7 There are 4 rows of stars with 5 stars in each row. How many stars?

8 A machine doubles a number, then adds 3. I put in 5. What comes out?

9 A pen costs $1.20. A ruler costs $0.85. How much for both?

10 A pizza is cut into 4 equal parts. I eat 3 parts. What fraction of the pizza did I eat?

Brain stretchers

11 I think of a number. I double it, then add 3, and I get 17. What was my number?

12 I am a 2-digit number. My tens digit is 2 more than my ones digit. My digits add up to 10. Who am I?

FOR THE TUTOR OR PARENT

Answer key and scoring

Accept equivalent forms (for example $2.05 and 2.05). One mark per question.

Warm-up (4 marks)

#	Question	Answer	Watch for
1	What is 10 more than 64?	**74**	Watch if the child changes the tens digit only. Common error: 65 (adds 1).
2	Which is smaller, 58 or 85?	**58**	Common error: reading digits the wrong way round. Ask which digit is the tens.
3	What is 16 - 9?	**7**	Look for a strategy (take 6 then 3, or count on from 9). Note if counting by ones.
4	What is 45 + 30?	**75**	Check the child adds tens to tens. Common error: 48 or 345.

Main questions (6 marks)

#	Question	Answer	Watch for
5	What is the value of the digit 6 in 462?	**60**	Common error: answering 6. Ask what 462 is made of (4 hundreds, 6 tens, 2 ones).
6	5_ + 27 = 81. What digit goes in the blank?	**4**	Look for working backwards (81 - 27 = 54). Common error: guessing 5 or 6.
7	There are 4 rows of stars with 5 stars in each row. How many stars?	**20**	Does the child skip count, repeat add (5+5+5+5) or know it? All fine. Common error: 9.
8	A machine doubles a number, then adds 3. I put in 5. What comes out?	**13**	Watch the order. Common error: 16 (adds 3 first, then doubles) or 8.
9	A pen costs $1.20. A ruler costs $0.85. How much for both?	**$2.05**	Watch for dollars and cents handled separately. Common error: $1.105 or $2.5.
10	A pizza is cut into 4 equal parts. I eat 3 parts. What fraction of the pizza did I eat?	**3/4**	Common error: 3/3 or 1/4. Ask what the bottom number tells us.

Brain stretchers (2 marks)

#	Question	Answer	Watch for
11	I think of a number. I double it, then add 3, and I get 17. What was my number?	**7**	Does the child work backwards (17 - 3 = 14, half of 14)? Or guess and check, which is also fine.
12	I am a 2-digit number. My tens digit is 2 more than my ones digit. My digits add up to 10. Who am I?	**64**	Look for a systematic list of pairs that add to 10. Common error: 73 or 55 (meets only one clue).

YOUR CHILD'S RESULT

Which level fits?

Add up the marks, then find your row. This is a guide. You make the final choice, and you can change level free of charge before lesson 1.

Warm-up marks: _____ / 4 **Main + stretch marks:** _____ / 8

Main + stretch	What it suggests
6 to 8	Join **Ages 8-9 (P2)**. Your child has the foundations and will be well challenged. If they scored 8 of 8 and all 4 warm-up marks, you can also try the Ages 9-10 (P3) check.
4 or 5	Join **Ages 8-9 (P2)**, and expect some support. If the warm-up score is 2 or less, Ages 7-8 (P1) may be the more comfortable start.
0 to 3	We suggest **Ages 7-8 (P1)**. The ideas build step by step, and a confident start matters more than a fast one.

Strong?
Choose the level that fits the score, not the school year. A child who finds this easy will enjoy the challenge questions in class.

Not yet?
That is useful to know, not a failure. Starting one level down means more success and more joy in class.

Skills covered

place value to 100; comparing and ordering; add and subtract within 100; numbers to 1000; missing digits; arrays and multiplication; two-step machines; money (dollars and cents); fractions; reasoning puzzles

Next step. Send the score and your preferred level to us when you enrol. Prices are the same at every level, and your tutor can talk it through first. Small groups of up to 8, live online.